

Daniel Chechelnitsky

📧 chechelnitskd — ✉ daniel.chechelnitsky@tecnico.ulisboa.pt — 🎓 Google Scholar

RESEARCH INTERESTS

translation technologies, machine translation, multilingual NLP, dialects, user perspectives

EDUCATION

Instituto Superior Técnico

Lisbon, Portugal

Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science and Engineering

Aug. 2024 – Apr. 2029

- Advisors: Giuseppe Attanasio, André Martins, & Maarten Sap

University of Michigan – Ann Arbor

Ann Arbor, MI

Master of Science in Computer Science and Engineering

Aug. 2022 – Apr. 2024

- Advisor: Nikola Banovic

Macalester College

Saint Paul, MN

Bachelor of Arts in Linguistics

Aug. 2018 – May 2022

- Advisor: Susan Fox

EXPERIENCE

SULI Intern

Jun. 2022 – Aug. 2022

Argonne National Laboratory

Lemont, IL

- Replicated AUC results from MOLI and Velodrome model papers
- Optimized hyperparameter training of MOLI using Ray tune
- Presented findings at SULI Summer Research Showcase

DSI Summer Lab Intern

Jun. 2021 – Aug. 2021

The University of Chicago - Data Science Institute

Chicago, IL

- Built an accessible mobile app using Flutter framework that uses deep learning models trained on Kaggle datasets to predict prostate cancer, skin cancer, and heart failure risk
- Demo-ed app and presented poster at DSI Summer Lab and Macalester College 2021 Summer Research Showcases

Software Development Intern

Nov. 2020 – Apr. 2021

GogyUp

Minneapolis, MN

- Designed, programmed and integrated 2 different NLP frameworks successfully into a Smart Dictionary App from spaCy Python library
- Compared 2 other implementations of text processing APIs in Python
- Presented 12 weekly Google Analytics website traffic reports at company meetings

PUBLICATIONS

Making a Name for Myself: On Academic Naming Policies and their Impact

A Pranav, Vagrant Gautam, Martin Mundt*, Jordan Taylor*, Arjun Subramonian*, Franziska Sofia Hafner*, Daniel Chechelnitsky*, William Agnew*, Anne Lauscher*

FAccT, 2026 [Best Paper Honorable Mention]

Not Like Us, Huntly: Measuring Perceptions and Behavioral Effects of Minoritized Anthropomorphic Cues in LLMs

Jeffrey Basoah*, Daniel Chechelnitsky*, Tao Long, Katharina Reinecke, Chrysoula Zerva, Kaitlyn Zhou, Mark Díaz, Maarten Sap

FAccT, 2025

Rejected Dialects: Biases Against African American Language in Reward Models

Joel Mire*, Zubin Trivadi Aysola*, Daniel Chechelnitsky, Nicholas Deas, Chrysoula Zerva, Maarten Sap

NAACL (Findings), 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

Jan. 2026 – Apr. 2026

Carnegie Mellon University

Pittsburgh, PA

- Created and maintained course website for 11-711: Advanced Natural Language Processing
- Held office hours, facilitated Piazza forums, and graded assignments and exams

Graduate Student Instructor

Aug. 2022 – May 2024

University of Michigan - Ann Arbor

Ann Arbor, MI

- Led two lab sections weekly for EECS 281: Data Structures and Algorithms & EECS 403: Graduate Foundations of Data Structures and Algorithms
- Held office hours, organized review sessions, and facilitated Piazza forums, graded assignments and exams

Instructional Aide

Jan. 2020 – May 2022

Macalester College

Saint Paul, MN

- Held office hours, graded assignments, and assisted in course planning across 5 semesters for Data Structures, Core Concepts in CS, Theory of Computation, Computer Systems, and Computational Linear Algebra

HONORS & AWARDS

- FAccT 2026 Best Paper Honorable Mention, 2026
- Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia (FCT) Studentship, 2024
- Computer Science Departmental Honors, Macalester College, 2022
- cum laude, Macalester College, 2022
- ASA DataFest 2021 Challenge Best Question Asked, 2021

PRESS

- Globe.AI Article (Not Like Us, Huntly)
- IBM Article (Rejected Dialects)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, C++, C, SQL (SQLite/MySQL), Dart, Elixir, Swift, JavaScript, R, HTML

Other Tools: Google Cloud, PyTorch, Keras, Prolific